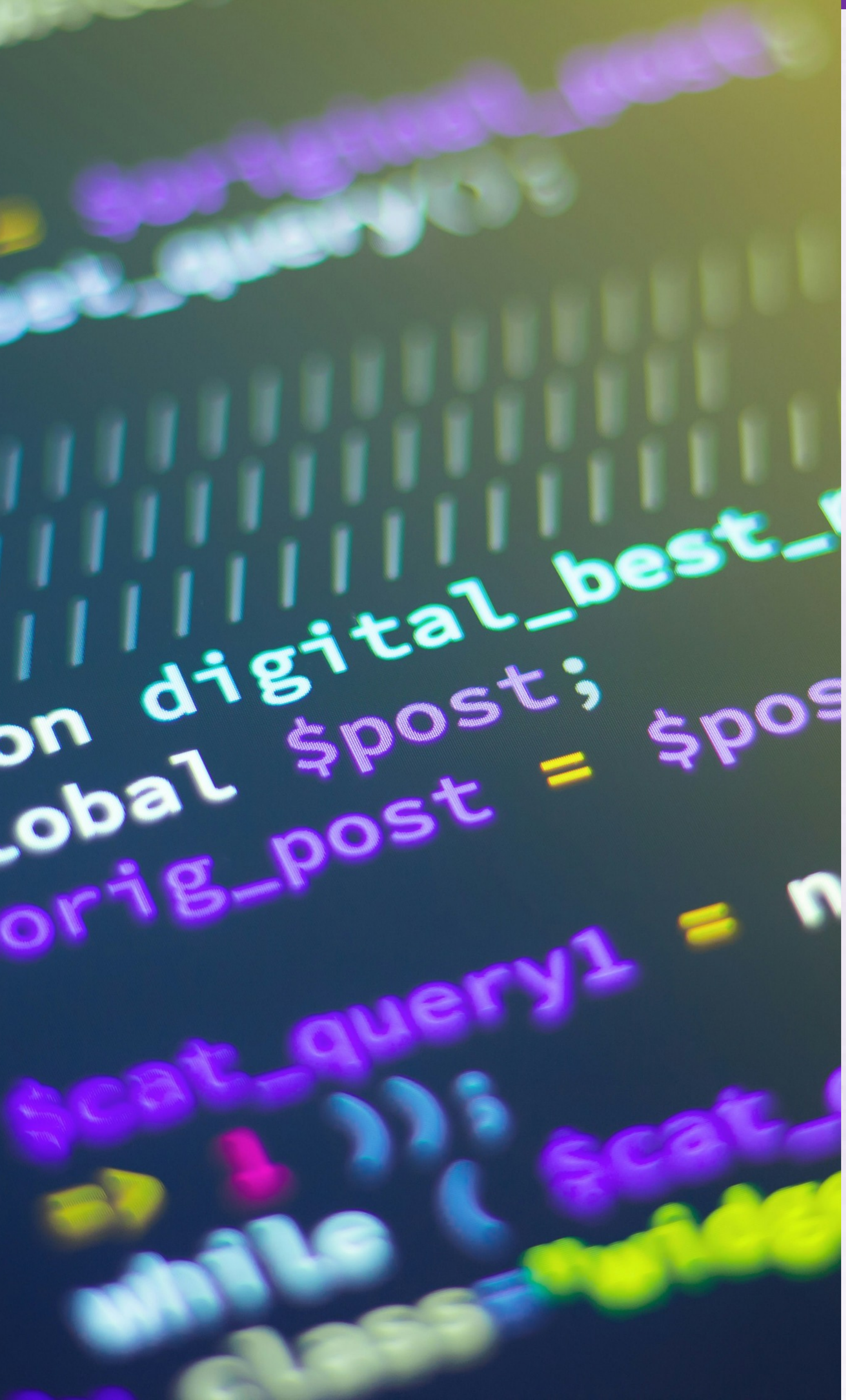


Triggers for System Decommissioning (End of Life, Migration, Risk)

IDENTIFYING KEY DRIVERS AND DECISION CRITERIA FOR DECOMMISSIONING LEGACY SYSTEMS

GRC GATE TRAINING

Introduction to System Decommissioning Triggers

Central topic: triggers for system decommissioning

- Focused on what drives the retirement of old systems in IT environments

Importance for IT environments of all sizes

- Applies to small business networks, large enterprises, and general interest in upgrading technology

Value of understanding when and why to retire systems

- Skill that benefits both individuals and organizations by ensuring up-to-date and safe technology usage

System Lifecycle and End-of-Life (EOL) Trigger

Systems become obsolete when needs are no longer met

- Obsolescence arises even in robust or initially well-designed systems

End-of-life (EOL) and end-of-support (EOS) as formal triggers

- Milestones from vendors indicating no further updates, patches, or support

Example: EOL causing security and compliance risk

- Running systems past EOL, like a 2010 enterprise server after 2020, leaves vulnerabilities unaddressed and can breach regulations

End-of-Support (EOS) and Planning

EOS may differ from EOL in vendor support details

- EOS can mean only paid or extended support is available before a final end-of-life

Importance of tracking support timelines

- Organizations must anticipate EOS/EOL dates to avoid unsupported products and manage transitions

Risks of running outdated technologies

- Outdated systems may lack updates, increasing vulnerability until full decommissioning

Migration to New Systems or Cloud

Migration to new or cloud systems as a trigger

- Advancements and efficiency lead businesses to migrate and decommission legacy systems

Cloud adoption example: updating email platforms

- Moving from on-premises email to services like Microsoft Office 365 or Google Workspace drives old system retirement

Key migration steps to prevent security risks

- Properly decommissioning old systems (including data transfer and dependency management) prevents security gaps

Migration Beyond the Cloud

Other migration scenarios trigger decommissioning

- Includes upgrading applications, consolidating after mergers, or moving to new technology stacks

Challenges of migration must be managed

- Includes ensuring data integrity, service availability, and retraining staff

Importance of planning and backup strategies

- Backup and rollback plans are essential to mitigate risks during transition periods

Risk-Based Triggers for Decommissioning

Unsupported systems may require early retirement due to risk

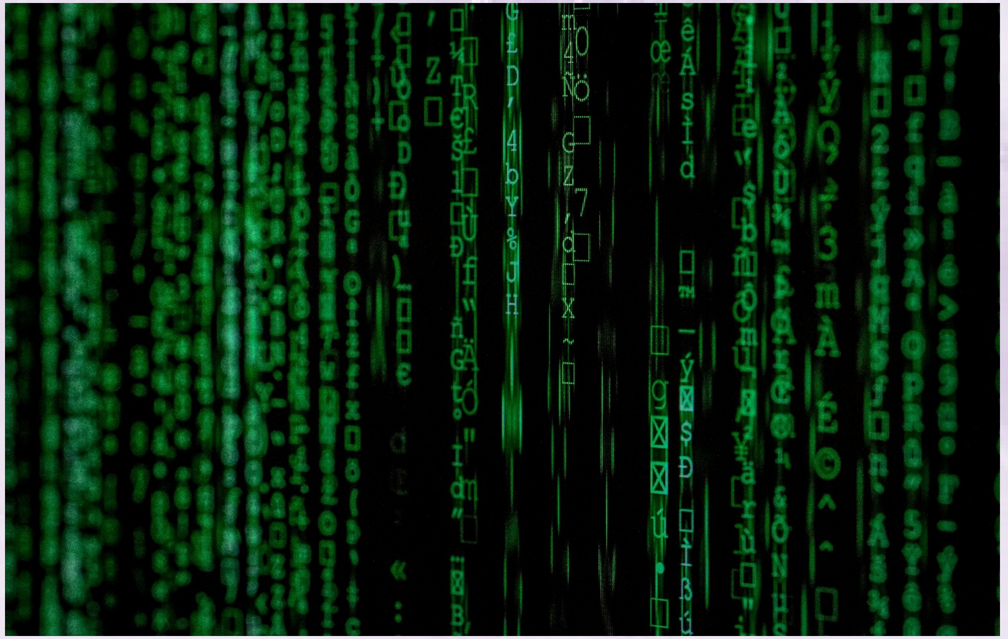
- Significant security vulnerabilities or compliance failures can necessitate decommissioning even before EOL

Unpatchable vulnerabilities drive urgent decisions

- Lack of vendor fixes or viable workarounds make continued operation risky

Legal and compliance penalties influence decommissioning urgency

- Regulatory requirements in fields like healthcare or finance increase the stakes for addressing at-risk systems



Compliance-Driven Decommissioning

Legal regulations often require system decommissioning

- Laws such as GDPR or HIPAA mandate strict data and security requirements

Legacy systems may lack necessary compliance features

- Absence of encryption or audit capabilities makes compliance impossible

Organizations must migrate to compliant solutions

- Non-compliant legacy systems are replaced to align with legal obligations

Business Continuity and Dependency Analysis

Maintain business continuity during decommissioning

- System retirement should not disrupt critical operations or lose important functionality

Scope of dependencies must be identified

- Both technical and organizational connections, like archival file servers, are evaluated before shutdown

Inventory tools reveal hidden dependencies

- Automated asset management, user surveys, and access logs help discover all system uses

Backups and Disaster Recovery in Decommissioning

Backups must be executed and retained before decommissioning

- Data should be migrated and verified in new systems prior to retirement

Disaster recovery and retention policies followed

- Backups are kept according to policy or legal requirements, sometimes for years

Failing to account for data needs creates risk

- Inadequate backup or retention can cause compliance issues and hinder audits

Stakeholder Involvement and Governance

Stakeholder approval is essential for system decommissioning

- All business units, IT, compliance, and executive management must review and agree to plans

Governance begins with formal proposals and review

- Requests outline rationale, risks, and strategies before oversight committees evaluate impacts

Governance ensures controlled, auditable decommissioning

- Documentation and logging of steps provide evidence for regulators, especially in regulated industries

Common Challenges in System Decommissioning

Resistance to change is a major challenge

- Users may be reluctant to leave legacy systems, so communication and training are key

Data loss risk during migration must be mitigated

- Test processes and maintain multiple backups to avoid losing information

Cost and technical complexity are barriers to timely decommissioning

- Hidden costs and lack of documentation can delay projects; phased or expert-driven approaches help

Summary of Decommissioning Triggers and Best Practices

Decommissioning is driven by EOL, EOS, migrations, and risk factors

- All these triggers necessitate review and structured transition away from legacy systems

Proper stakeholder collaboration and governance are mandatory

- Formal frameworks and collective involvement guarantee smooth, secure decommissioning

Diligent planning ensures an effective, low-risk outcome

- Best practices reduce risk, control costs, and future-proof organizations